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1MORE Piston Fit

Slightly ahead of the Omega in performance

The 1MORE Piston Fit is a trendy looking, well built and quite popular in-ear headphone in the budget segment. By the looks of it, the Piston Fit seems like a modern reimagining of the Piston Classic from the same company. I've been enjoying a few of the 1MORE products that I've had a chance to review recently. After testing the 1MORE Single Driver a couple of months ago, and liking it quite a bit, I was curious to find out for myself if the Piston Fit holds up past favourites. Let's find out.



Build and design

The 1MORE Piston Fit comes in a variety of colours which apparently are designed to match with the colours of the iPhone. While I got the greenish blue variant and it's pretty nice to look at, there are other colours such as but other than that there are other colours such as Space Gray, Silver and Rose Gold. The metal housing, which is made from an aluminium alloy, feels sturdy and manages to lightweight. The silicon tips are angled at 45-degrees resulting in a more ergonomic insertion angle and better fit. Though the quality of the tips could've been better – they are slightly more rigid and reduce the isolation / seal slightly. The cable quality is fairly decent. In fact the core is reinforced with kevlar fibre and is protected by a TPE outer layer. They don't look like they'll survive absolute careless usage but I'm pretty sure some amount of rough-play should be fine.

Features

There isn't much to say about the 1MORE Piston Fit in terms of features because they're a pair of pretty basic and rather functional in-ear



headphones. While the MEMS microphone does garner few points in the features department, finding only a single button inline remote was a bit of a downer. In contrast the Brainwavz Omega (also priced at ₹999) offers a three button remote. The accessories that come in the box – like few pairs of different sized silicon tips are pretty standard.

Performance

The 1MORE Piston Fit delivers great performance for its price. When I'd reviewed the Brainwavz Omega, I'd found its bass to be a little overwhelming for my taste. That was, in fact, one of my main cribs about it. I was hoping someone would release a pair of budget in-ears with a more true-to-source bass end. The 1MORE Piston Fit fulfils that wish perfectly. They deliver performance that is a shade ahead of the Brainwavz Omega but with a more realistic bass response. Since they are so close in price and performance, a lot of comparisons will be made in this review; so please bear with me. After listening to a whole gamut of test tracks spanning a variety of genres, there were some rather curious conclusions I was

able to arrive at regarding the sound signature and tuning of the 1MORE Piston Fit. I like to debut any new pair with a barrage of instrument heavy tracks. So, *Pull Me Under - Dream Theater* was one of the first tracks I threw at it. The sharp guitar layering and vocals by James Labrie came through quite well. The sweeping bass notes were not tight as I'd want them to be, but at least the amount of bass wasn't overwhelming. In tracks like *Money For Nothing - Dire Straits*, though the Brainwavz was a little better with reproduction in the higher ranges. For instance the sharp solitary guitar felt more natural on the Brainwavz Omega compared to the 1MORE Piston Fit. The slightly bumped up bass side also makes EDM more enjoyable on the Omega – not that it sounds bad on the Piston Fit, it's just that those genres demand exaggerated bass. One of the other observations was that the Piston Fit is slightly more difficult to drive than I expected. Much of my listening was done on the Asus Xonar Essence STX but on non-amped portable devices you'll notice you need to up the gain into the red to really open them out.

Verdict

The Piston Fit does well for its price. Sure, there's no carry sleeve or the remote is single button, but the pure audio performance is decent. If there's one thing you take away from this review, it is this: if you listen to tracks with heavy instrumentation and layering (such as metal or progrock), then these are the budget in-ears for you. If you like big bass (and you cannot lie), and your genres of choice include EDM, hip hop, and pop, you are better off with the Brainwavz Omega. You want an even more tldr verdict? Totally worth the price – is all we can say.

—Siddharth Parwatay

SPECIFICATIONS

FREQUENCY RANGE: 20-20,000 Hz | PLUG: 3.5 mm Gold Plated | COLOR: Space Gray / Silver / Rose Gold / Blue | WEIGHT: 14g | IMPEDANCE: 32 Ohms

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